

shows you as being negative and difficult to work with. The best way to answer this one is to think for a while and then say something like, “I’ve always got on just fine with my coworkers, actually.”

17. Is there anyone you just could not work with?

No. Well, unless you’re talking about murderers, racists, rapists, thieves, or other dastardly characters, you can work with anyone. Otherwise you could be flagged as someone who’s picky and difficult if you say, “I can’t work with anyone who’s a Broncos fan. Sorry.”

18. Tell me about any issues you’ve had with a previous boss.

Arrgh! If you fall for this one you shouldn’t be hired anyway. The interviewer is testing you to see if you’ll speak badly about your previous supervisor. Simply answer this question with extreme tact, diplomacy, and, if necessary, a big fat loss of memory. In short, you’ve never had any issues.

19. Would you rather work for money or job satisfaction?

It’s not a very fair question, is it? We’d all love to get paid a Tim Cook-like

salary doing a job we love, but that’s rare indeed. It’s fine to say money is important, but remember that *nothing* is more important to you than the job. Otherwise, you’re just someone looking for a bigger paycheck.

20. Would you rather be liked or feared?

I have been asked this a lot, in various incarnations. The first time I just drew a blank and said, “I don’t know.” That went over badly, but it was right at the start of my career when I had little to no experience. Since then I’ve realized that my genuine answer is “Neither; I’d rather be respected.” You don’t want to be feared because fear is no way to motivate a team. You may get the job done, but at what cost? Similarly, if you’re everyone’s best friend, you’ll find it difficult to make tough decisions or hit deadlines. But when you’re respected, you don’t have to be a complete bastard or a lame duck to get the job done.

21. Are you willing to put the interests of the company ahead of your own?

Again, another nasty question. If you say yes, you’re a corporate whore who doesn’t care about family. If you say no, you’re disloyal to the company.